Zhining Sun

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Academic Positions

2026.8–	Assistant Professor & E. Koller Chair in Agricultural Information Systems	University of Minnesota, Department of Applied Economics

Education

2021–2026	Ph.D. in Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics	The Ohio State University
2019–2021	M.S. in Environmental Economics and Urban Planning Certificate in Spatial Data Analytics	Tufts University
2016–2019	B.A. in Economics; B.A. in Financial Management	University of Minnesota Morris

Research Interests

Agricultural Economics, Commodity Markets, Agribusiness, Agricultural Finance, Industrial Organization

Publications

Sun, Z., R. Chandio, and A. L. Katchova. "How Crop Forecast Similarity, Government Policies, and Macroeconomic Conditions Affect WASDE Forecast Accuracy." *Agribusiness*, accepted.

Sun, Z., A. L. Katchova, A. K. Giri, and D. Subedi. 2026. "MFP and CFAP Official Announcement and Pre-Official Announcement Effects on the Corn and Soybean Futures Market." *Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy* 48(2): 397–407. [doi]

Sun, Z. and A. L. Katchova. 2026. "The Relationship Between Interest Rates and Agricultural Commodity Price Dynamics." *Agribusiness* 42(3): 1301–1315. Published online in 2024. [doi]
Ranked among the top 10% most-viewed papers published in the journal in 2024 (Wiley recognition, 2025).

Katchova, A. L. and Z. Sun. 2024. "Statistics and Research on New and Beginning Producers Using Census of Agriculture Data." *Choices* 39(4): 1–5. [link]

Burks, S. V., J. E. Anderson, B. Panda, H. S. Haider, R. Haider, D. Shi, Y. Li, M. Cagle, D. Ostroushko, Z. Sun, J. Zaharick, J. Hickman, E. Mabry, M. Berger, C. Czeisler, and S. N. Kales. 2020. "The Pre-Registry Commercial Driver Medical Examination: Screening Sensitivity and Certification Lengths for Two Safety-Related Medical Conditions." *Journal of Occupational and Environmental Medicine* 62(3): 237–245. [doi]

Working Papers

Sun, Z., S. Lee, and A. L. Katchova. "Evolving Markups of Agricultural Input Firms under GE Adoption." Submitted.

Kang, M., S. Lee, I. Sheldon, and Z. Sun*. "India's Transition from Corn Exporter to Importer: Ethanol Expansion and the Reconfiguration of Global Corn Trade." First round R&R.

*Corresponding author.

Work In Progress

Sun, Z., & S. Bora. "The Source of Bank Market Power and Agricultural Credit Resilience"

Conference Presentations

Sun, Z., & S. Bora. "The Source of Bank Market Power and Agricultural Credit Resilience" Selected presentation, NC1177, Salt Lake City, UT, November 3–4, 2026, expected.

Sun, Z., S. Lee, & A. L. Katchova. "Evolving Markups of Agricultural Input Firms under GE Adoption." Poster presentation, gricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO, July 26–28, 2026.

Sun, Z., A. L. Katchova, A. K. Giri, and D. Subedi. "The Announcement Effect of MFP and CFAP on Commodity Future Contracts." Paper presentation, NCCC-134, Chicago, IL, April 14–15, 2025.

Sun, Z., A. L. Katchova, A. K. Giri, and D. Subedi. "The Announcement Effect of MFP and CFAP on Commodity Future Contracts." Selected paper presentation, Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, July 28–30, 2024.

Sun, Z., R. Chandio, and A. L. Katchova. "Herding in the WASDE." Selected poster presentation, Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, July 28–30, 2024.

Sun, Z. and A. L. Katchova. "The Relationship between Interest Rates and Agricultural Commodity Price." Selected presentation, NC1177 Agricultural Finance Regional Group, Atlanta, GA, October 12–13, 2023.

Sun, Z. and A. L. Katchova. "Impact of Interest Rates on Agricultural Commodity Price Dynamics." Selected paper presentation, Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, July 23–25, 2023.

Teaching Experience

Instructor

- AEDECON 3103 Principles of Agribusiness Finance, The Ohio State University, Spring 2025.

Lab Instructor

- AEDECON 6110 Applied Quantitative Methods, The Ohio State University, Autumn 2023.

Teaching Assistant

- UEP 0194-03 Real Estate Development and Planning, Tufts University, Spring 2021.
- ECON 1111 Principles of Microeconomics, University of Minnesota Morris, Autumn 2018.

Guest Lecturer

- AEDECON 8202 Agricultural Finance, Ph.D. field seminar, "Futures Market and Methodologies in Announcement Effect," The Ohio State University, Autumn 2024.
- AEDECON 6110 Applied Quantitative Methods I, master's course, "Simple Linear Regression," two lectures, The Ohio State University, Autumn 2024.
- AEDECON 3103 Principles of Agribusiness Finance, "Corporate Financial Statements and Ratios" and "Farm Financial Statements," two lectures, The Ohio State University, Autumn 2024.

Extension and Outreach

Outreach Reports

Katchova, A., Z. Sun, and D. Cohen. 2026. "Recent Trends in Agricultural Land Loss to Development in Ohio." *Water Cooler Economics*, Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, July 2026. [link]

Katchova, A., G. Lade, Z. Sun, and J. Wu (alphabetical order). 2026. "How Much Farmland Is Ohio Losing?" *Substack*, June 2026. [link]

Katchova, A., G. Lade, Z. Sun, and J. Wu (alphabetical order). 2026. "Measuring Agricultural Land and Land Loss in Ohio: Why the Numbers Differ Across Datasets." *AEDE Bulletins*, Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, June 2026. [pdf]

Sun, Z. and C. Chen. 2025. "Economic Perspective of Livestock Market under Current Market Condition." *AEDE Bulletins*, Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, October 17, 2025. [pdf]

Katchova, A., Z. Sun, and D. Cohen. 2025. "Agricultural Land Lost to Development in Ohio." *AEDE Bulletins*, Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, April 15, 2025. [pdf]

Fang, X., Z. Sun, A. L. Katchova, and R. Chandio. 2024. "Ohio Farmland Trends and Preservation." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, February 13, 2024. [link]

Sun, Z., H. Wu, and A. L. Katchova. 2024. "Cost Estimation for the Ohio Beginning Farmer Tax Credit Program." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, February 13, 2024. [link]

Sun, Z., X. Fang, and A. L. Katchova. 2023. "Beginning Farmer Tax Programs." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, August 3, 2023. [pdf]

Fang, X., Z. Sun, A. L. Katchova, and C. Zoller. 2023. "Characteristics of Beginning Farmers in Ohio and Potential Impact of the Ohio Beginning Farmer Tax Credit Program." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, July 28, 2023. [link]

Sun, Z., A. L. Katchova, and S. Lee. 2023. "Economic Perspective on the U.S. Agricultural Commodity Market for the 2022/23 Marketing Year." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, January 24, 2023. [link]

Ding, K., Z. Sun, A. L. Katchova, and J. Hadrich. 2022. "Ohio Farm Finances for 2020." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, September 16, 2022. [link]

Fang, X., Z. Sun, A. L. Katchova, and J. Hadrich. 2022. "Ohio Crop Production and Farm Operation Benchmarking for 2020." Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University, September 16, 2022. [link]

Outreach Presentations

Katchova, A. L. and Z. Sun. "Ohio Farm Income/Financial Conditions." Ask the Expert, OSU Farm Science Review, London, OH, September 16, 2025.

Katchova, A., Z. Sun, and D. Cohen. "Agricultural Land Lost to Development in Ohio." Economic Outlook and Policy Webinar, April 16, 2025. [slides]

Katchova, A. L. and Z. Sun. "Ohio Farm Income/Financial Conditions." Ask the Expert, OSU Farm Science Review, London, OH, September 17, 2024.

Katchova, A. L., X. Fang, R. Ju, Z. Sun, V. Sharma, and C. Smith. "Preserving Ohio Farms and Ohio Farmland." Presentation to Ohio Farm Bureau, February 14, 2024. [link]

Media Mentions

"USDA Says Farm Income Decline Less Than Expected." *Lancaster Farming*, September 18, 2024. [link]

Service

Contributed journal reviews for *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*, *Agricultural Economics*, *Applied Economic and Perspective*, *Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics*, *Agribusiness: An International Journal*, *Agricultural Finance Review*, and *Agriculture and Human Values*.

Honors and Fellowships

- Outstanding Publication Award, AEDE, The Ohio State University, 2026.
- Top 10% Most-Viewed Paper Published in 2024, *Agribusiness* (Wiley), 2025, for "The Relationship Between Interest Rates and Agricultural Commodity Price Dynamics."
- Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Graduate Student Extension Competition, Top 10 Finalist, 2025.
- Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Graduate Student Extension Competition, Top 9 Finalist, 2024.
- Best Second-Year Paper Award, AEDE, The Ohio State University, 2023.
- Edward F. Hayes Advanced Research Forum Poster Award, Second Prize, College of Food, Agricultural, and Environmental Sciences, The Ohio State University, 2023.
- Environmental Fellowship, The Ohio State University, 2022–2023.
- University Fellowship, The Ohio State University, 2021–2022.

- Tuition Scholarship, Tufts University, 2019–2021.
- Morris Academic Partnership, University of Minnesota Morris, 2018–2019.
- MDM Rubicon Scholarship, University of Minnesota Morris, 2018–2019.